

CASE STUDY

Communicate with Confidence

A Rise 360 microlearning course for new employees on written, verbal, and remote workplace communication

Tool	Articulate Rise 360 (responsive, block-based authoring)
Role	Instructional Designer (sole designer/developer)
Audience	New employees / freshers, first 0–3 months on the job
Timeline	Single build session, ~6 hours, scoped intentionally for quality over quantity
Deliverable	5-topic course + graded assessment, published as Web/HTML5 output

Project Overview

Communicate with Confidence is a short, self-paced microlearning course designed to help new hires navigate the communication challenges of their first few months on the job — writing clear emails and chat messages, speaking up in meetings, and collaborating effectively across remote and hybrid channels. The course was built as a deliberate contrast to my earlier Storyline 360 portfolio pieces: where those projects demonstrated custom interactivity through triggers, states, and layers, this project was scoped to show a different but equally valuable skill — designing efficient, polished training quickly using a block-based authoring tool built for speed.

The Challenge

The brief I set for myself was to design and build a complete course in a single 6-hour session, while still meeting the instructional standards of my earlier projects. That meant resisting the temptation to cover every possible communication topic, and instead scoping tightly: one clear audience (new employees), one coherent thread (written, verbal, and remote communication), and just enough interactivity per lesson to reinforce learning without dragging out the build.

A secondary challenge was tool fluency — this was my first Rise 360 build. Several early sessions were spent learning Rise-specific conventions (for example, that Enter vs. Shift+Enter creates a lesson versus a section header, or that theming is locked until at least one lesson exists in the outline).

Design Process (ADDIE)

Analyze

Defined the target learner (a new employee in their first weeks) and identified three recurring pain points from that period: unclear written communication, hesitation to speak up in meetings, and confusion over which channel to use for remote/hybrid collaboration.

Design

Mapped a 5-topic storyboard before opening Rise at all, specifying block type, on-screen text, and design rationale for every screen. This front-loaded planning was what made the 6-hour build realistic — content decisions were made on paper, not live inside the tool.

Develop

Built the course in Rise 360, using a mix of Statement, List, Tabs, Labeled Graphic, Flashcards, Process, Scenario, Sorting Activity, Knowledge Check, and Quiz blocks. Practice Knowledge Checks were placed after each content-heavy lesson (ungraded, unlimited attempts) with a single graded, retry-limited Quiz reserved for the end — a deliberate formative-vs-summative assessment split.

Implement

Published via Web/HTML5 export, consistent with the publishing approach used across my Storyline projects, and hosted for review via GitHub Pages.

Evaluate

Ran a full learner-perspective preview pass before publishing, catching and correcting several issues along the way (detailed below) — including an assessment-design flaw where the correct answer was clustering in the same position across multiple questions.

Key Design Decisions

Formative vs. summative assessment

Each of the four content lessons ends with a short, ungraded Knowledge Check with unlimited attempts — purely for reinforcement. The final Quiz, by contrast, is graded (80% passing score, shuffled answer choices, 2 attempts) and sits in its own dedicated lesson. Keeping practice and assessment visually and structurally distinct reflects a deliberate instructional choice, not just a default tool setting.

Answer-position bias check

During a build review, I noticed the correct answer was landing in the same position (option 2) across several Knowledge Checks — a pattern a learner could exploit without engaging with the content. I manually reordered every affected question and enabled Rise's Shuffle Answer Choices setting on the final Quiz so no positional pattern exists for any learner.

One decision point in the Scenario block

Rise's Scenario block supports multi-step branching, but I intentionally scoped the meeting-disagreement scenario to a single decision point with three response options and tailored feedback (including a character-expression change per outcome) rather than building a longer branching path — enough to teach the judgment call without expanding the time budget.

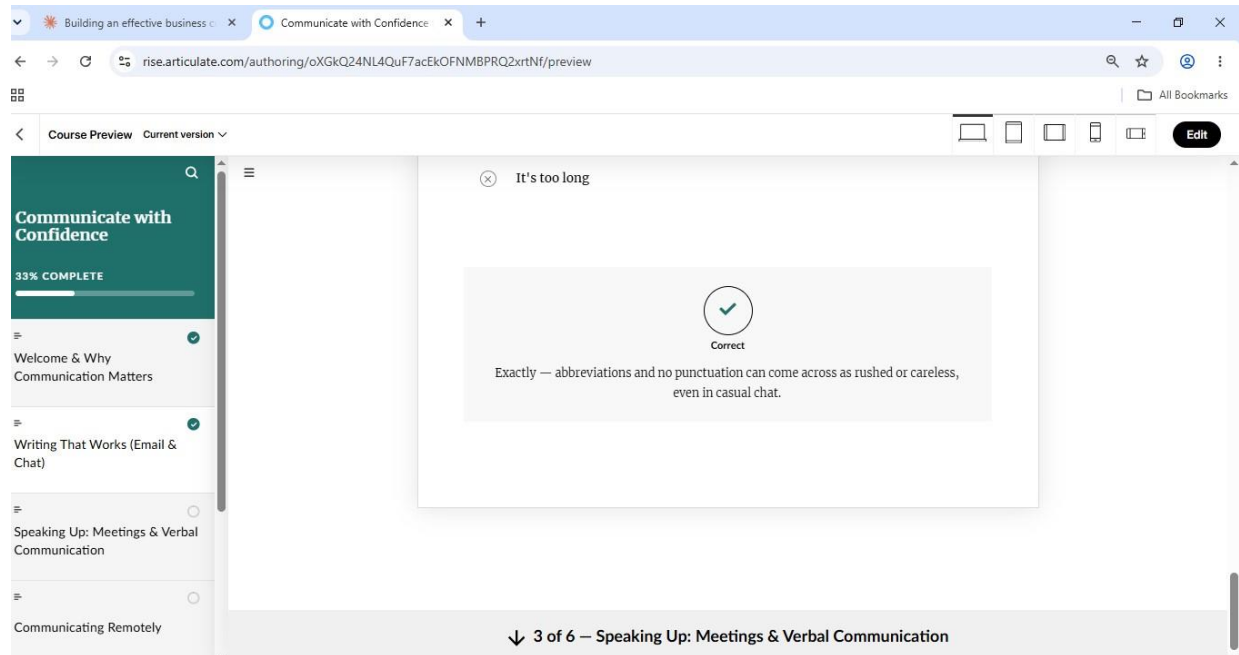
Interactive Sorting instead of a second static comparison

The original storyboard planned a Tabs block to compare synchronous vs. asynchronous communication tools. During the build, I replaced this with a single drag-and-drop Sorting Activity instead, since a second static Tabs block back-to-back with Lesson 2's would have felt repetitive. This kept the lesson more varied without adding build time.

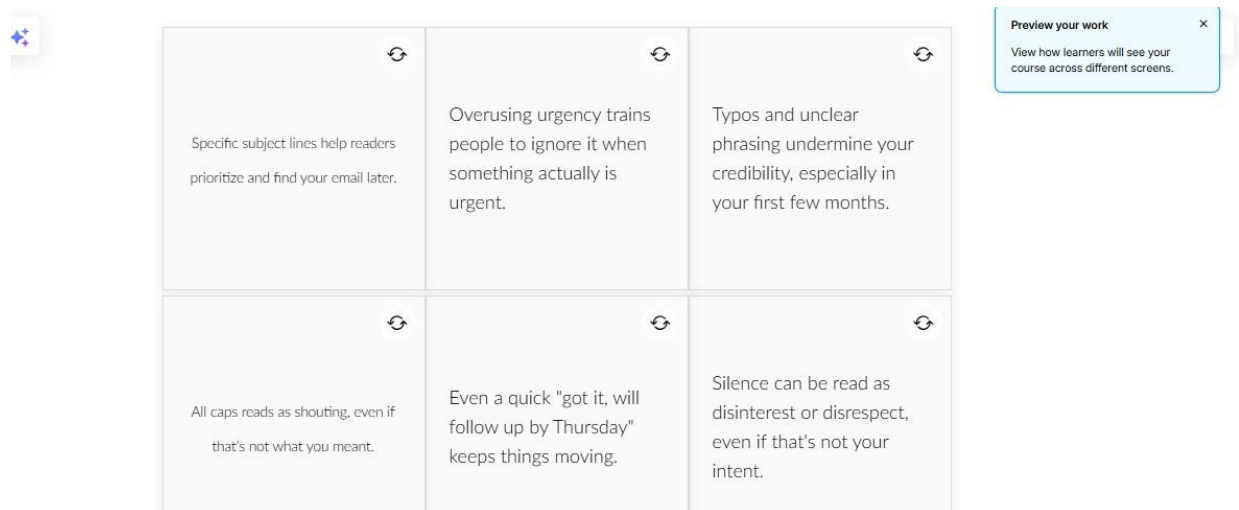
Accessible color contrast

The course theme uses a custom teal (#1F6F6B, matching my recruiter portfolio palette) with Rise's "Auto" contrast setting enabled, which automatically selects accessible text/button coloring against the theme color per WCAG guidance.

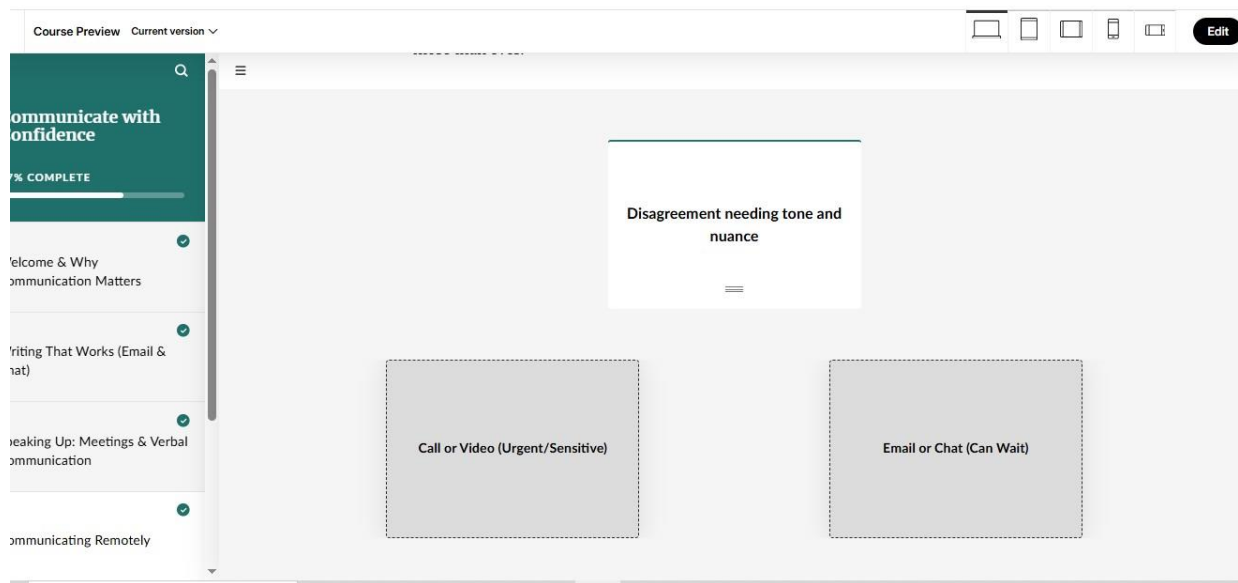
Selected Screens



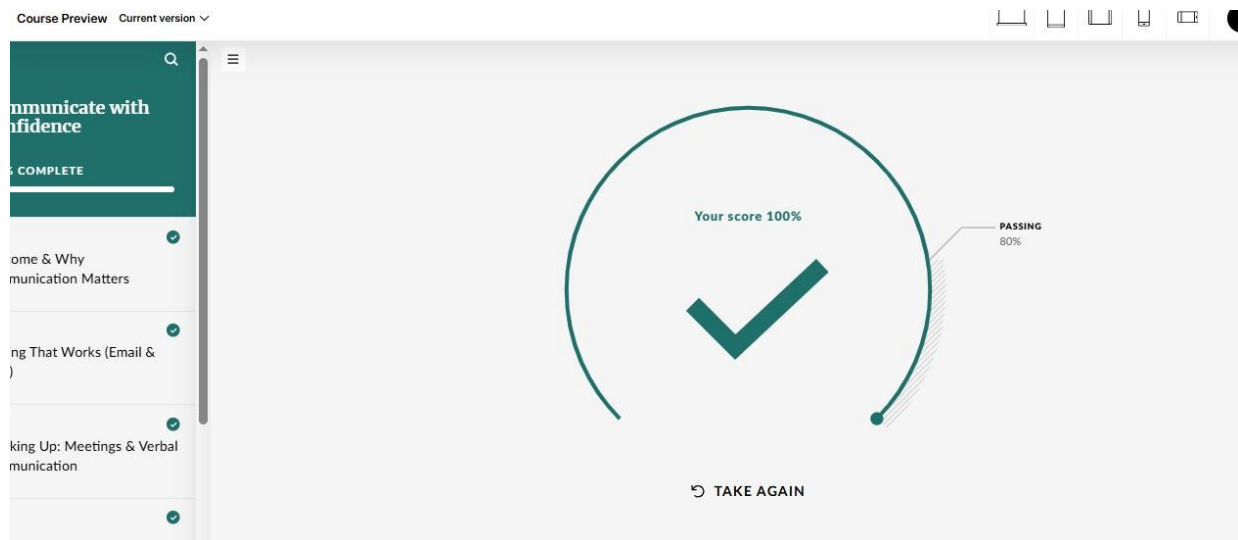
Labeled Graphic — "Anatomy of a Professional Email," built on an actual mock email screenshot so hotspots align with real email components.



Flashcards — Email Do's and Don'ts, alternating pattern for rhythm and scannability.



Sorting Activity — learners drag workplace scenarios into "Call/Video" or "Email/Chat," reinforcing channel-selection judgment.



Graded Quiz results screen — 80% passing threshold, shuffled answer choices, 2 attempts.

Known Limitations & Trade-offs

- Theme options were limited to 3 starter templates under the free trial account; a paid subscription would unlock a broader template library.
- Rise's Statement and List blocks don't expose a separate heading field — headings were embedded as bolded lead-in text within the body copy, or paired with an adjacent Text block where a true heading was needed.

- The Scenario block's font-size auto-scaling on shorter text (visible briefly on two Flashcards during build) isn't user-configurable; the fix was lengthening the copy slightly rather than overriding a style setting, since none exists.
- The course was built and tested in a single browser session without multi-device QA beyond Rise's built-in preview; a production rollout would benefit from testing on additional real devices.

Skills Demonstrated

- ADDIE-based instructional design applied to a compressed timeline
- Rapid authoring in Articulate Rise 360, including Labeled Graphic, Scenario, Sorting, and Quiz block types
- Formative vs. summative assessment design
- Assessment quality assurance (answer-position bias correction, shuffle settings)
- Accessible color/contrast decision-making
- Scoping discipline — deliberately trading breadth for depth within a fixed time budget